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Market Briefs **Pro**

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Good morning, Pro Briefers!

Over the last few years, the global economy has begun to shift.

What was once a global economy dominated by the U.S. - and U.S. trade agreements - is now being challenged by a new group: BRICS.

What's that? The BRICS nations are a major partnership of emerging market countries. More specifically, the core of BRICS is made up of the following countries:

- **Brazil**
- **Russia**
- **India**
- **China**
- **South Africa**

BRICS was formed to foster trade relations and political affiliations beyond traditional Western economies like the U.S. and European countries.

And now, these countries are gaining ground on the U.S. economy, with strengthening currencies, and economies, which is where we have identified a Broad Market Shift:

Opportunities for investors within BRICS developing markets are growing due to U.S. isolationism, tariffs, and economic and market volatility.

Let's break down why investors may want to keep an eye on this potential opportunity, starting with the basics.

First, BRICS formed in 2009 and contained only the five countries we listed above.

BRICS' expanding membership



BRICS MEMBERSHIP

-  Original members, plus SA
-  Countries that recently joined as full members
-  Partnership countries under consideration

Data [via](#) Institute for Security Studies

So then, where's the opportunity? *BRICS is growing.* Broad U.S. tariffs have put pressure on several countries, causing them to form new alliances and move business away from the U.S.

- Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, the United Arab Emirates, and Indonesia are now also member nations of BRICS.
- Other countries like Vietnam, Cuba, and more are also partnered with the organization, which means they are able to collaborate, but are not yet able to vote in the decisions of the organization.

The bottom line: 20 countries make up BRICS, which account for 30% of the world's nominal GDP, and around 55% of the world's working age population.

- The U.S. accounts for roughly 15% of the world's GDP and almost 5% of the world's working age population.

BRICS has become the strongest trade bloc in the world - and it's expanding quickly.

ANALYST REPORT

Tickers we're tracking:

ETFs: EZA, TUR

BRICS Companies: VEON

We went deeper into the research - check out more details from this report [here](#).

MARKET SHIFT

Push From The Dollar

But how does BRICS growing create opportunities for investors?

Some emerging markets have seen explosive growth as the U.S. economy has been volatile in the last two decades.

That has led to volatility in the value of U.S. dollars.

Flashback: The U.S. has been the global reserve currency since 1944.

That means most of the world's central banks hold U.S. dollars to save, invest, and exchange with other countries.

Why? Because for almost a century, the dollar has been very stable - backed by the strength of the U.S. economy and military.

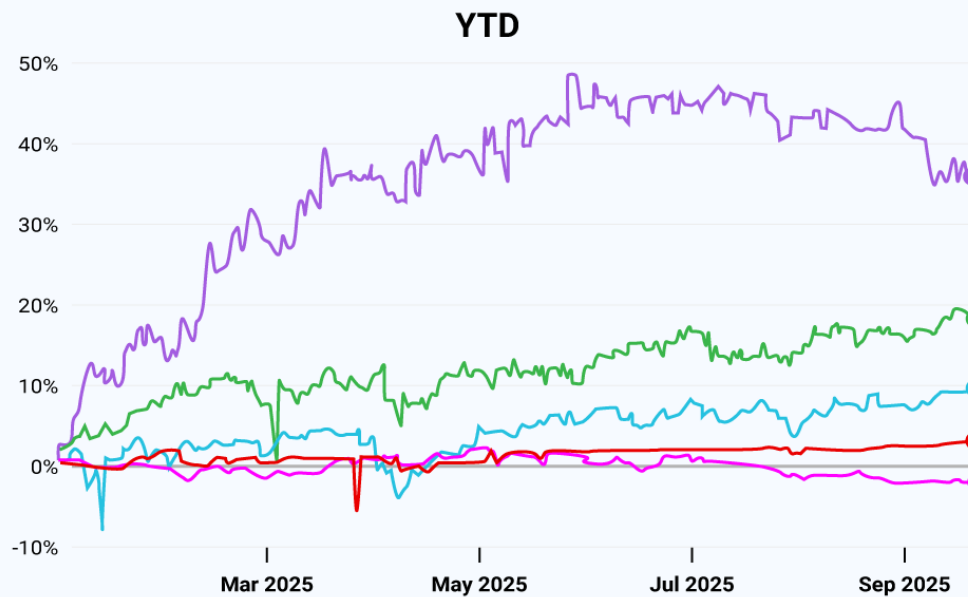
- Countries want to use a stable currency to reduce exchange rate risk, which makes the value of money and trade more predictable.

Flashforward: Rising U.S. debt, tariffs, and global tensions have put pressure on the U.S. dollar, causing some parts of the world to move towards other currencies.

- Major rating agencies like Moody's and Fitch have downgraded the U.S.'s credit in recent years, making it more risky to invest in the country.

Now, the currencies of the five core nations of BRICS are all strengthening against the U.S. dollar in 2025.

BRICS currencies performance in 2025



BRL/USD	0.1868	+0.0281	↑ 17.73%
CNY/USD	0.1406	+0.0036	↑ 2.61%
ZAR/USD	0.0577	+0.0047	↑ 8.97%
INR/USD	0.0113	-0.0003	↓ 2.46%
RUB/USD	0.0120	+0.0032	↑ 36.04%

Data [via](#) Google Finance

And while the U.S. dollar is still the dominant reserve currency, this is beginning to change.

That strengthening value has led other nations to begin increasing their reserve holdings of BRICS currencies, further strengthening these countries' markets and economies.

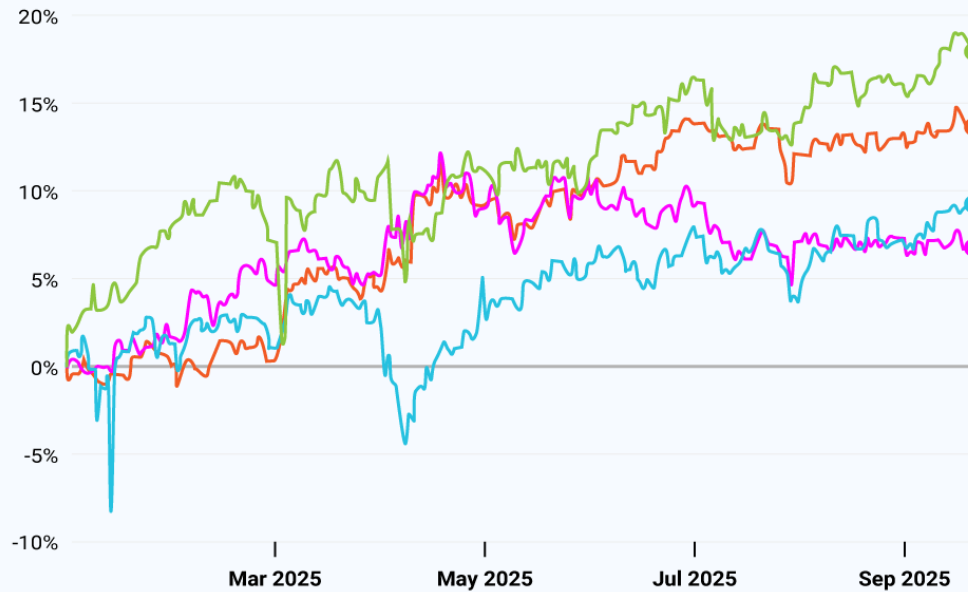
The iShares Brazil and China ETFs are up 36% and 37% respectively in 2025 - the S&P 500 has increased only 13% this year.

Only the iShares India ETF is down compared to the S&P 500 in 2025 - bogged down by 50% tariffs from the U.S. and companies that rely on international trade.

- While Brazil also has a high tariff from the U.S., its ETF is more weighted towards energy and financial companies, so it's less impacted by tariffs.

BRICS currencies vs other world currencies

YTD



BRL/USD	0.1868	+0.0281	↑ 17.73%
ZAR/USD	0.0577	+0.0047	↑ 8.97%
EUR/USD	1.1773	+0.1422	↑ 13.74%
JPY/USD	0.0068	+0.0004	↑ 6.67%

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Data [via](#) Google Finance

Opportunities within the BRICS nations are growing though, as investors look beyond the U.S. dollar to other currencies and economies showcasing strong growth.

BRICS

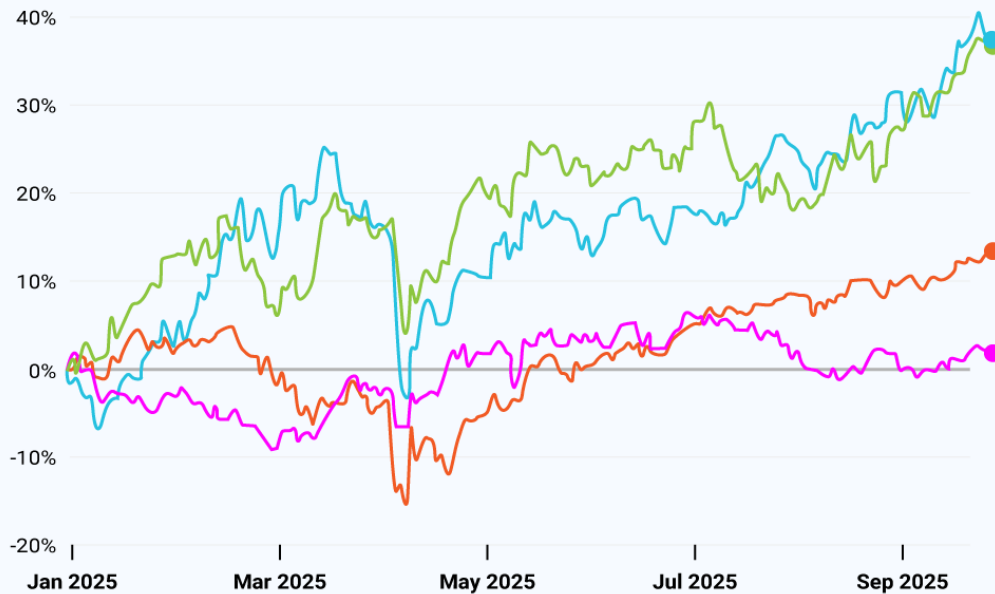
The S In BRICS

The core of BRICS is Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.

American investors do not have access to the ETFs or individual companies based in Russia, due to sanctions from the Russia-Ukraine war.

We've also already mentioned the China, India, and Brazil iShares ETFs and have written reports about those opportunities in the recent past.

iShares Brazil, China, and India ETFs vs the S&P 500



Ishares Msci Brazil...	\$30.71	+\$8.20	↑ 36.43%
S&P 500	6,680.58	+798.95	↑ 13.58%
iShares MSCI India...	\$53.54	+\$0.90	↑ 1.71%
iShares MSCI Chin...	\$64.38	+\$17.52	↑ 37.38%

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Image [via](#) Google Finance

- Those iShares ETFs offer investors broad exposure to mid-sized companies located in China, India, and Brazil.

That leaves us with South Africa - a growing economy and opportunity for investors.

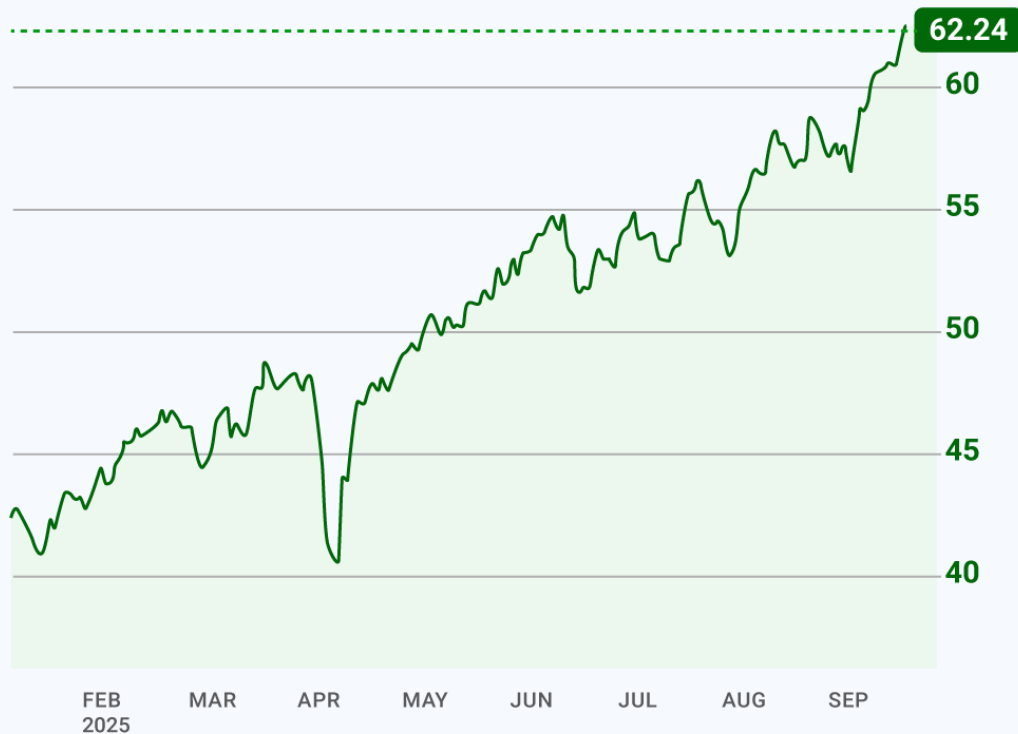
What opportunity? The iShares MSCI South Africa ETF (EZA) gives investors an easy way to access multiple mid-sized companies based in South Africa.

iShares MSCI South Africa ETF (EZA)

YTD Price



62.24
(48.51%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

In 2025, the ETF has grown by 50%, not only beating the S&P 500, but other BRICS related ETFs as well.

When South Africa first joined BRICS back in 2010, it recorded two straight years of record GDP growth.

So far this year, the South African economy has been growing, which has meant more inflows and growth for the iShares South African ETF.

It is composed of 27 companies, with over 60% of the fund investing in materials or financial companies, think banks and mining companies.

More specifically, over 16% of the fund invests in one company: Naspers Limited.

Naspers is a South-African based tech investment and media company.

Top 10 holdings for the iShares MSCI South Africa ETF (EZA)

Ticker	Name	Sector	Asset Class	Market value	Weight(%)
NPN	NASPERS LIMITED LTD CLASS N	Consumer Discretionary	Equity	\$71,611,954.26	15.38
GFI	GOLD FIELDS LTD	Materials	Equity	\$47,670,851.93	10.24
ANG	ANGLOGOLD ASHANTI PLC	Materials	Equity	\$44,372,258.63	9.53
FSR	FIRSTRAND LTD	Financials	Equity	\$29,892,097.45	6.42
VAL	VALTERRA PLATINUM LTD	Materials	Equity	\$27,446,594.83	5.89
SBK	STANDARD BANK GROUP	Financials	Equity	\$23,012,873.60	4.94
CPI	CAPITEC LTD	Financials	Equity	\$19,091,866.58	4.10
IMP	IMPALA PLATINUM LTD	Materials	Equity	\$16,210,401.11	3.48
HAR	HARMONY GOLD MINING COMPANY LIMITE	Materials	Equity	\$15,833,049.34	3.40
MTN	MTN GROUP LTD	Communication	Equity	\$15,501,099.42	3.33

Image [via](#) iShares

It owns Media24, South Africa's largest print and digital media business.

The company also has a key stake in Takealot, which is the largest ecommerce company in South Africa.

- Naspers was an early investor in Chinese tech-giant Tencent, acquiring \$32 million in Tencent back in 2001.

That stake is reportedly worth \$221 billion in 2025, which is over three times the market value of Naspers.

Why does this matter? Naspers may benefit as the South African economy grows, because of the businesses that it invests in.

That may mean the South African ETF also continues to grow, leading to potential profits for investors.

The other top 10 holdings for EZA are precious metal mining companies and major South African banks.

- Almost 4% of the fund invests in Valterra Platinum Limited, the world's largest platinum producer.

Platinum is one of the world's most valuable precious metals, with the price of platinum currently valued at over \$1,400 per ounce - up over 80% in the last five years.

South Africa is the largest producer of platinum in the world, another reason why its economy has grown, in addition to its BRICS membership.

DIRECT INVESTMENT

The UAE Joins In

The United Arab Emirates (UAE) became a part of BRICS in January 2024, and its GDP reached an all-time record high last year, hitting \$537 billion.

- The UAE has seen its GDP rise every year since 2020 and has almost doubled in the last 20 years.

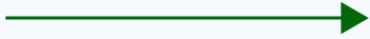
UAE's government-owned investment fund, MGX, also took a large stake in TikTok U.S. in September 2025, furthering its place in the new global economy.

- MGX, alongside Oracle and Silver Lake, now own 45% of TikTok, a stake valued at \$14 billion.

Dubai is the financial and commercial center of the UAE and also home to another opportunity for investors, VEON Ltd. (VEON).

VEON Ltd. (VEON)

5 Year Price



55.26
(65.11%)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

VEON is a telecommunications company, which has a strong focus on its international business.

It has shown strong growth since the UAE and Dubai became a member nation of BRICS, but even before the UAE joined BRICS, *VEON was growing*.

According to the company's latest 20-F earnings report, every one of its market segments grew year-over-year in 2024.

Becoming a member of BRICS has allowed it to expand its international operations to other member countries even faster as well.

- Pakistan applied for BRICS membership in 2023, which is VEON's largest market segment.

Top markets for VEON Ltd.

(In millions of U.S. dollars)	Total revenue 2024 2023		Adjusted EBITDA 2024 2023	
Pakistan	1,382	1,119	584	502
Ukraine	925	919	518	541
Kazakhstan	854	774	442	421
Bangladesh	520	570	180	214
Uzbekistan	273	268	100	112
Others	55	55	18	22
HQ and eliminations	(5)	(7)	(151)	(200)
Total	4,004	3,698	1,691	1,612

Data [via](#) VEON

However, the company did take a slight hit after 2020 due to its exposure to the Russian ruble.

The Russian ruble lost over 50% of its value in the year following its invasion of Ukraine, but has since bounced back, and has even appreciated in value against the dollar this year.

- The ruble is up over 36% compared to the dollar so far in 2025.

What does this mean? Growth and stability with the ruble and other currencies has allowed VEON to grow its business in recent years.

VEON Ltd. 2024 20-F assets and equity

In Millions \$	2024	2023
Assets		
Non-current assets		
Property and equipment	3,016	2,898
Intangible assets	1,510	1,619
Investments and derivatives	65	53
Deferred tax assets	368	312
Other assets	177	178
Total non-current assets	5,136	5,060
Current assets		
Inventories	15	23
Trade and other receivables	463	542
Investments and derivatives	357	433
Current income tax assets	63	58
Other assets	241	200
Cash and cash equivalents	1,689	1,902
Total current assets	2,828	3,158
Assets classified as held for sale	72	-
Total assets	8,036	8,218
Equity and liabilities		
Equity		
Equity attributable to equity owners of the parent	1,099	858
Non-controlling interests	158	213
Total equity	1,257	1,071

Data [via](#) VEON

Share prices for VEON are down from the record highs it set back in 2021, but are still up over 65% over the last five years.

That's partly because now that Dubai and the UAE are a part of BRICS, its country and major companies may be more likely to use BRICS related currencies.

In fact, the sovereign wealth fund of the UAE has increased investments in Chinese and Russian companies and industries in recent years.

More trade in the Chinese yuan and Russian ruble means a stronger currency, and stronger growth for the companies that deal in those currencies, like VEON.

- VEON's EBIT (earnings before interest and taxes) rose by \$200 million year-over-year.

VEON Ltd. 2024 20-F Cash Flows

In Millions \$

	2024	2023
Operating activities		
Profit before tax	704	559
Non-cash adjustments to reconcile profit before tax to net cash flows		
Depreciation, amortization and impairment loss, net	731	729
(Gain)/ loss on disposal of non-current assets	(5)	(46)
Gain on disposal of subsidiaries	(145)	-
Finance costs	495	531
Finance income	(49)	(60)
Other non-operating gain, net	(31)	(20)
Net foreign exchange gain	(9)	(81)
Changes in trade and other receivables and prepayments	(81)	(1)
Changes in inventories	(9)	(19)
Changes in trade and other payables	130	143
Changes in provisions, pensions and other	73	125
Interest paid	(431)	(489)
Interest received	43	53
Income tax paid	(266)	(264)
Net cash flows from operating activities from continuing operations	1,150	1,160
Net cash flows from operating activities from discontinued operations	-	951
Investing activities		
Purchase of property, plant and equipment	(627)	(531)
Purchase of intangible assets	(280)	(235)
Payment on deposits	(19)	(54)
Outflows on loan granted	(80)	(66)
Receipts from / (investment in) financial assets	92	(147)
Acquisition of a subsidiary, net of cash acquired	(2)	-
Proceeds from sales of share in subsidiaries, net of cash	36	-
Proceeds from sales of property, plant and equipment	102	14
Other proceeds from investing activities, net	-	(1)
Net cash flows used in investing activities from continuing operations	(778)	(1,020)
Net cash flows used in investing activities from discontinued operations	-	(1,217)

Data [via](#) VEON

Investments in the UAE are still very limited to American investors - but VEON stands as an opportunity for investors to join in the growth BRICS is having on the nation and its companies.

TURKEY

New Members, New Opportunities

Switching back to ETFs, another growing BRICS opportunity for investors is the iShares MSCI Turkey ETF (TUR).

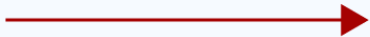
Turkey is not yet a member of BRICS, but is a partner nation, and has applied for full membership.

BRICS has made it clear to the rest of the world that it is looking to expand quickly, so it seems likely that Turkey will become a full member of BRICS in the near future.

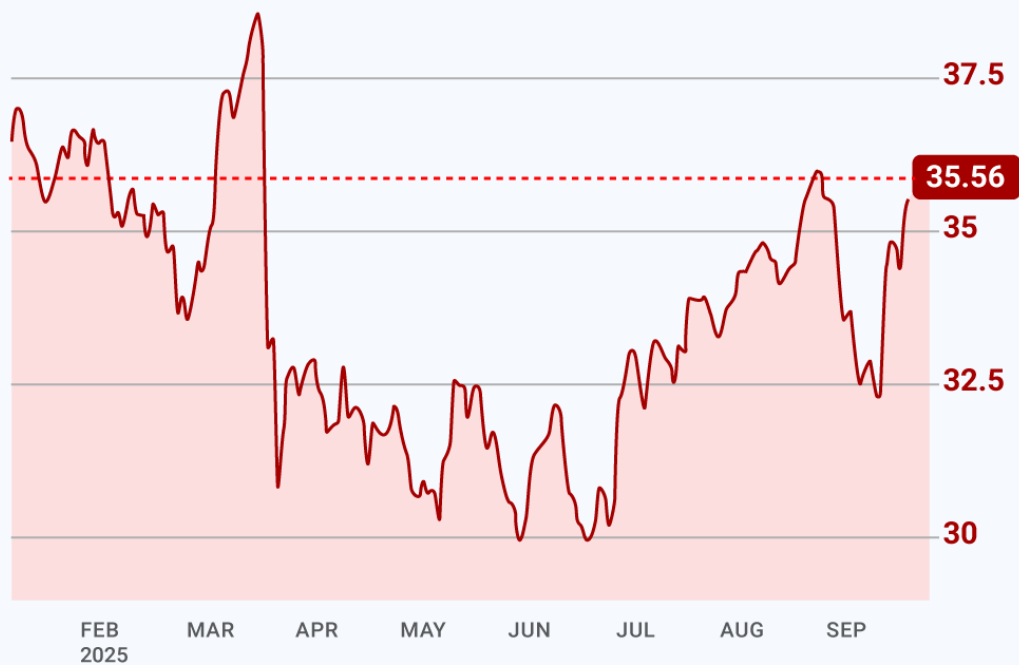
When it does, its country and companies will gain access to the trade advantages that BRICS has to offer, which may help its businesses and GDP to grow faster.

iShares MSCI Turkey ETF (TUR)

YTD Price



35.56
(-2.04%)



Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Turkey is also facing a 15% tariff from the U.S. on all imported goods, which has led the country to seek alternate trading partners.

Because it's not yet a BRICS member nation though, the ETF is down around 2% YTD - however, it's up over 76% in the last five years, proving its worth as a solid long-term investment.

The ETF's success is partly due to the rapid growth of the Turkish economy. Turkey's GDP has grown every year since 2020.

- Its GDP hit a record high of \$1.3 trillion in 2024, growing by almost \$600 billion since 2020.

The ETFs top two holdings by weight are Aselsan Elektronik and Birlesik Magazalar. Both companies are beating the S&P 500 in 2025.

Aselsan Elektronik is a defense manufacturer, which has become a major supplier to the Turkish armed forces. It also is a major exporter of military equipment to central Asia.

Birlesik Magazalar operates one of the largest chain super markets in Turkey and has recently expanded its operations to Egypt, which was recently added as a member country to BRICS.

Top 10 holdings of the iShares MSCI Turkey ETF (TUR)

Ticker	Name	Sector	Asset Class	Market value	Weight (%)
ASELS.E	ASELSAN ELEKTRONIK SANAYI VE TICAR	Industrials	Equity	\$14,713,331.38	8.47
BIMAS.E	BIM BIRLESIK MAGAZALAR A	Consumer Staples	Equity	\$12,604,533.24	7.25
AKBNK.E	AKBANK A	Financials	Equity	\$10,913,607.11	6.28
TUPRS.E	TURKIYE PETROL RAFINERILERI A	Energy	Equity	\$9,773,147.20	5.62
THYAO.E	TURK HAVA YOLLARI AO A	Industrials	Equity	\$7,374,097.30	4.24
KCHOL.E	KOC HOLDING A	Industrials	Equity	\$7,227,957.11	4.16
ISCTR.E	TURKIYE IS BANKASI C	Financials	Equity	\$6,809,447.68	3.92
TCELL.E	TURKCELL ILETISIM HIZMETLERI A	Communication	Equity	\$6,290,701.86	3.62
YKBNK.E	YAPI VE KREDI BANKASI A	Financials	Equity	\$6,016,453.84	3.46
EREGL.E	EREGLI DEMIR VE CELIK FABRIKALARI	Materials	Equity	\$5,392,627.07	3.10

Data [via](#) iShares

- Aselan Elektronik is up 194% YTD and 2,500% over the last five years, consistently beating expectations.

- Birllesik Magazalar is only up 2.55% YTD, but 686% in 5-years, and holds a large number of price targets above its current, with a consensus rating of "Buy."

Most of the ETF is concentrated in industrials and financials.

Industrial companies, which typically make large machinery, don't often see large swings in growth, as that industry is more cyclical to a nation's economy.

But, financial sectors often do see growth, and with Turkey likely to join BRICS soon, the TUR ETF may also be poised for strong growth.

RISKS

Political Alliances - Political Risks

Geopolitical risks to American investors could limit the benefits from this shift.

How? The U.S. restricted investments into Russian companies after the war between Russia and Ukraine broke out - it could do the same with other BRICS nations.

Relations within BRICS nations could also break down, leading to issues in trade and possibly currencies losing value.

Investors should also be aware of the longer-term risks as well.

When the European Union formed, it initially saw rapid growth. But, recession in both Germany and Greece have impacted the entire Union.

A similar situation with BRICS could unfold in the future, as many of the partner nations are largely still emerging and have underdeveloped economies.

While we do expect these partner and full member nations of BRICS to grow, there's always a chance that they can't keep up on a global scale.

Lastly, foreign investments, even through ADRs, always leave U.S. investors open to exchange-rate risk.

This is the risk of loss due to currency fluctuations, so investors looking to capitalize on this shift will want to keep an eye on the value of currencies around the world in relation to the U.S. dollar.

REVIEW

The Times, They Are A Changing

BRICS is growing.

That challenges U.S. and European dominance on the world stage, but also creates new investment opportunities for investors.

Many nations, like South Africa, the UAE, and Turkey, have grown after joining or partnering with BRICS.

ETFs that focus on the growing companies in these countries are increasing in share price as a result, along with individual names like VEON.

As of today, the U.S. is still the dominant world super power when it comes to trade and will be a major player for years to come.

But as BRICS develops, it seeks to tilt that trade in its favor, which is why investors will want to keep this shift in mind over the coming years.



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